Covariant superstrings and compactification

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Overview of covariant string theory prepared for the High-energy Theory Group at Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile.
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Introduction
- The role of string theory
- How to use it?
- The need for covariant superstrings

Superstrings

Covariant superstrings

Hybrid strings
- Flux deformed Calabi-Yau compactification

Pure spinor strings

Conclusion

Tools *versus* Physics

The role of string theory is as a calculational tool for quantum field theories coupled to gravity.

TOOL	$\longleftrightarrow$	PHYSICS
Calculus		classical mechanics
Functional Analysis		quantum mechanics
QFT		Fundamental fields with spin ≤ 1
Strings		Fundamental fields with spin ≤ 2
$\vdots$		$\vdots$

Note increasing symmetry and decreasing generality.

Compactification and Holography

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- Example: To get $N = 4$ super-Yang-Mills we start with a stack of many D3-branes at weak string coupling. Increasing the coupling gives $AdS_5 \times S^5$ with 5-form flux on the S^5.

Superstrings

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Supersymmetry in field theory

$$\left.\begin{array}{c} \delta\phi = \epsilon\psi \\ \delta\psi = \bar{\epsilon}\partial\!\!\!/\phi \end{array}\right\} [\delta, \delta] \sim \bar{\epsilon}\gamma^m\epsilon\partial_m$$

Superstrings

Supersymmetry in string theory

world-sheet	space-time
$\delta x^m = \epsilon \psi^m$	$\delta x^m = i\epsilon\gamma^m\theta$
$\delta \psi^m = \bar{\epsilon}\partial x^m$	$\delta\theta = \epsilon$

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Open superstrings

RNS$\pm$ spin structure:	GS$\pm$ spin structure:
(anti-)periodic B.C.	space-time (anti-)Weyl
$S \sim \int (\partial x)^2 + \psi\partial\psi$	$S \sim \int \Pi^2 + S_{\mathrm{WZ}}$
	$\Pi^m = \mathrm{d}x^m + i\theta\gamma^m\mathrm{d}\theta$

Superstrings

Closed superstrings

	left-moving	right-moving	
SUSY	$1\pm$	0	Heterotic O/E
	$1\pm$	$1\pm$	Type II A/B

Superstrings

Hidden symmetries

RNS	GS
Spacetime SUSY	Worldsheet Siegel symmetry
$\{\psi_0^m, \psi_0^n\} = 2g^{mn}$	$\delta\Pi^m = \mathrm{d}\bar{\theta}\gamma^m\delta\theta$ $\delta\theta = \not{\Pi}\kappa$
vacuum: spacetime spinor	generated by $\not{\Pi}d$

Superstrings

Hidden symmetries

RNS	GS
Bosonization $\bar{\psi}\psi \sim i\partial H$	Light-cone gauge
$(\psi_0^m \pm J^m{}_n \psi_0^n) = \mathrm{e}^{i(\pm H_0 \pm \cdots \pm H_4)}$	$\gamma^+\theta = 0$
$\downarrow$ GSO-projection	$\Downarrow$
$\Theta_{\mathbf{s}} = \mathrm{e}^{i\sum_a s_a H_a}$	x^i , S^a (triality)

Superstrings

Benefits/drawbacks

RNS	GS
Super-Virasoro	Unitary gauge
$\psi\Theta \sim \frac{1}{\sqrt{z}} \dots$	$p_\theta = \frac{\delta S}{\delta \dot{\theta}} \sim i\bar{\theta}\gamma^m \partial x_m + \dots$

Superstrings

Quantization

RNS	GS
Super-Virasoro constraints 1st class	Mixed 1st and 2nd class
Covariant quantization	Non-covariant quantization
Trivial Ramond backgrounds	Trivial NS backgrounds

Neither possible for mixed backgrounds.

Covariant superstrings

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Siegel constraints $\qquad d = p_\theta + i\bar{\theta}\gamma^m \partial x_m + \theta\theta\partial\theta\text{-term}$

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Operator products $\quad d_\alpha(z) d_\beta(0) \sim \frac{1}{z}(\gamma^m)_{\alpha\beta}\Pi_m(0)$

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2. Pure spinor strings

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	"spacetime"	"internal"
matter	x^m, ψ^m	$y^i, \bar{y}^{\bar{\imath}}, \psi^i, \bar{\psi}^{\bar{\imath}}$
ghost	b, c, β, γ	

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Berkovits	$\downarrow$	$\downarrow$
variables	$x^m, p_\alpha, \theta^\alpha, \bar{p}_{\dot{\alpha}}, \bar{\theta}^{\dot{\alpha}}, \rho$	$y^i, \bar{y}^{\bar{\imath}}, \psi^i, \bar{\psi}^{\bar{\imath}}$

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Examples

$$
\begin{aligned}
(\theta^\alpha) &\sim \exp \frac{i}{2}\left(-i\phi \pm (H_0 + H_1) - H\right) \\
(\bar{\theta}^{\dot{\alpha}}) &\sim c\xi \exp \frac{i}{2}\left(3i\phi \pm (H_0 - H_1) + H\right)
\end{aligned}
$$

Hybrid strings

Canonical operator products

Hybrid strings

Canonical operator products

$$y^i(z,\bar{z})\bar{y}^{\bar{\jmath}}(0) \sim \delta^{i\bar{\jmath}} \log|z|^2 \ , \ \psi^i(z)\bar{\psi}^{\bar{\jmath}}(0) \sim \frac{\delta^{i\bar{\jmath}}}{z} \ , \ \rho(z)\rho(0) \sim -\log z$$

$$x^m(z,\bar{z})x^n(0) \sim \log|z|^2 \ , \ p_\alpha(z)\theta^\beta(0) \sim \frac{\delta_\alpha^\beta}{z} \ , \ \bar{p}_{\dot{\alpha}}(z)\bar{\theta}^{\dot{\beta}}(0) \sim \frac{\delta_{\dot{\alpha}}^{\dot{\beta}}}{z}$$

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Super-Virasoro constraints

$$\begin{aligned}
T &= \Pi^m\Pi_m + d\partial\theta + \bar{d}\partial\bar{\theta} + \delta_{i\bar{\jmath}}\partial y^i\partial\bar{y}^{\bar{\jmath}} + \delta_{i\bar{\jmath}}\psi^i \overleftrightarrow{\partial} \bar{\psi}^{\bar{\jmath}} \\
G^+ &= \mathrm{e}^\rho d^2 + i\delta_{i\bar{\jmath}}\psi^i\partial\bar{y}^{\bar{\jmath}} \\
G^- &= \mathrm{e}^{-\rho}\bar{d}^2 + i\delta_{i\bar{\jmath}}\bar{\psi}^{\bar{\jmath}}\partial y^i \\
J &= -\partial\rho - \delta_{i\bar{\jmath}}\bar{\psi}^{\bar{\jmath}}\psi^i
\end{aligned}$$

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$$\mathrm{Rep}_4 \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \Phi(x, \theta, \bar{\theta}, p, \bar{p}, \rho)$$

$$\mathrm{Rep}_6 \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \sum \Omega_{i_1 \ldots i_p \bar{\jmath}_1 \ldots \bar{\jmath}_q}(y, \bar{y}) \psi^{i_1} \ldots \psi^{i_p} \bar{\psi}^{\bar{\jmath}_1} \ldots \bar{\psi}^{\bar{\jmath}_q}$$

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$$d(z)\Phi \sim \frac{1}{z} D\Phi \quad , \quad \bar{d}(z)\Phi \sim \frac{1}{z} \bar{D}\Phi$$

$$D = \frac{\partial}{\partial\theta} + i(\bar{\theta}\sigma^m)\frac{\partial}{\partial x^m} \quad , \quad \bar{D} = -\frac{\partial}{\partial\theta} - i(\sigma^m\theta)\frac{\partial}{\partial x^m}$$

Superspace covariant derivatives

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Superspace covariant derivatives with algebra

$$\{D, D\} = 0 \ , \ \left\{D, \bar{D}\right\} = -2i\sigma^m\partial_m \ , \ \left\{\bar{D}, \bar{D}\right\} = 0$$

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"Chiral ring" of "internal" space $\Leftrightarrow$ cohomology ring.

(Anti-)chiral fields

Spin-$\frac{3}{2}$ generators

(Anti-)chiral fields

Spin-$\frac{3}{2}$ generators

Correlated	$G^+ = G_4^+ + G_6^+,$	$G^- = G_4^- + G_6^-$	and	$J = J_4 + J_6$
or				
Anti-corr.	$G^+ = G_4^+ + G_6^-,$	$G^- = G_4^- + G_6^+$	and	$J = J_4 - J_6$

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Spacetime chiral superfields correlated with internal chiral ring
or
spacetime anti-chiral superfield correlated with chiral ring and
vice versa.

Calabi-Yau compactification

Type IIB string on Calabi-Yau X

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Left- and right-moving SCAs (Type II)

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	(chiral,chiral)	(chiral,anti-chiral)
spacetime	$N = 2$ chiral	$N = 2$ twisted-chiral
multiplet	vector	hyper
cohomology	$H^{2,1}_{\bar\partial}(X)$	$H^{1,1}_{\bar\partial}(X)$
deformation	$\mathbb{C}$-structure	Kähler-structure

Calabi-Yau compactification

Vector-multiplets (chiral,chiral)

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Integrated vertex operator

$$I^p = \int G_L^+(G_R^+(M^p)) + \text{h.c.} = \int \mathrm{e}^{\rho_L + \rho_R}(d_L d_R) D^p_{+-} + \text{h.c.} + \dots$$

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Flux deformed background preserving D3 symmetry (Klebanov-Strassler)

$$X^p_{--} = 0 = X^p_{+-} \qquad X^p_{++} \sim g_s \bar{G}^p \quad \text{(ISD flux)}$$

Flux deformation

Vertex operator for flux deformation

Flux deformation

Vertex operator for flux deformation

$$I_{\mathrm{D3}} = \sum_{p=1}^{h^{2,1}} I^p \Omega^p = \int G_L^+(G_R^+(M^p)) + \mathrm{h.c.}$$
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Cancel with *spacetime* gravitational vertex operator.

Warping

In flat space

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At 1-loop therefore $\boxed{\Delta A \sim g_s^2 |G|^2}$

Warp factor of the spacetime metric ([5] with Brenno Carlini Vallilo).

Significance

The results of the work with Brenno Carlini Vallilo have many implications:

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Unfortunately, "picture-changing problem" persists...

Pure spinor strings

In ten dimensions we can introduce spinor harmonics to separate constraints

$$\{d_\alpha, d_\beta\} = -2i(\gamma^m)_{\alpha\beta}\Pi_m \quad \rightarrow \quad \left\{\lambda^\alpha d_\alpha, \lambda^\beta d_\beta\right\} = -2i\,(\lambda\gamma^m\lambda)\,\Pi_m$$

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$$U = \lambda^\alpha A_\alpha(x,\theta) \in H^1_Q \quad \Rightarrow \quad U = \Gamma^m A_m + \Gamma_\alpha \chi^\alpha - Q(G)$$

where $\Gamma^m = \lambda\gamma^m\theta$ and $\Gamma_\alpha = -\frac{1}{2}(\theta\gamma^{mpq}\theta)(\lambda\gamma_{mnq})_\alpha$ span the 0-momentum cohomology at ghost number 1.

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Cohomology corresponds to a photon A_m and photino χ^α.

Pure spinor strings

Applications

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- Compactification and relation to hybrid

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Open problems

- Looks like gauge fixing of a superstring with some fermionic symmetry. *Which string ??*
- Spectrum
- ...

In other news...

Hybrid

- Compactification on $K3$, $K3 \times T^2$ [2], CY_3, CY_4, ...
- Flux compactification on CY [1, 3], superpotentials, non-commutativity, ...
- Superstring field theory, black holes, amplitudes, ...

Pure spinor

- Compactification on CY [4]
- $AdS_5 \times S^5$ background and possible proof of Maldacena duality
- Integrability in the $AdS_5 \times S^5$ sigma model [5]

Fin

Thank you!

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